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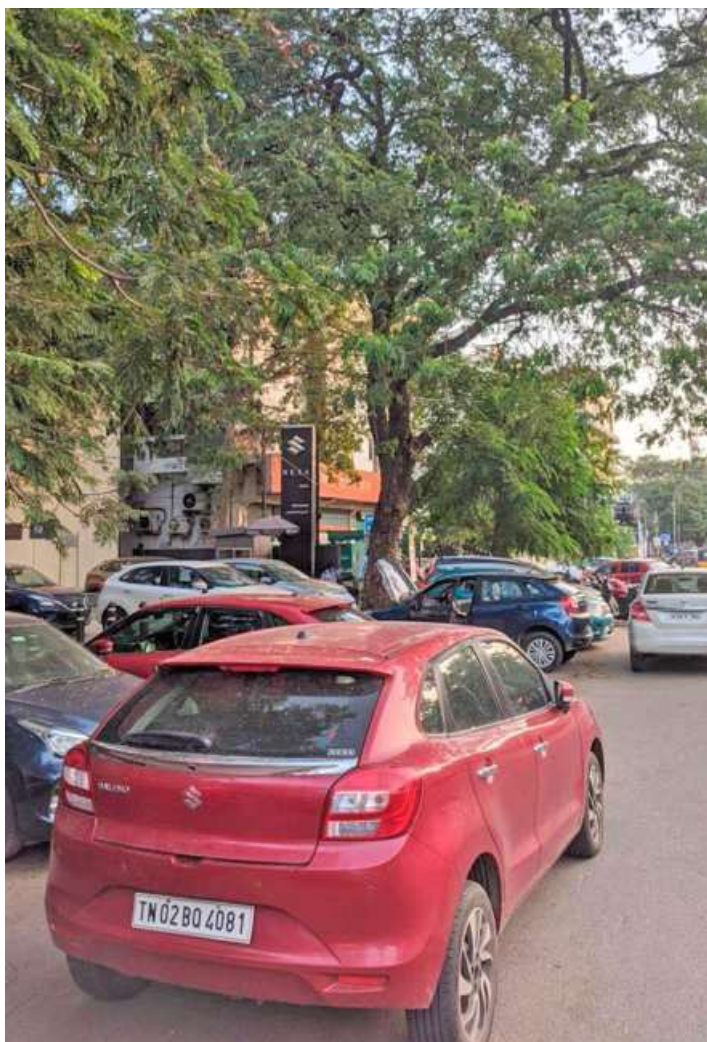
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Anna Nagar residents bring up unfinished business

Residents in the Anna Nagar Assembly Constituency want initiatives that started well but petered out to be revived



PRINCE FREDERICK

Measures diluted can be worse than measures never taken. A thread left hanging may never be picked up again. Those two lines encapsulate the overarching concern of the Federation of Anna Nagar Residents' Associations (FOARA). Sandhya Vedullapalli, secretary of FOARA, which represents 25 residents' welfare associations across Anna Nagar and Anna Nagar East, wants the elected to the Anna Nagar Assembly Constituency to attend to unfinished business immediately after assuming office. She observes that FOARA's wish list is there for all the candidates in the fray to study; the Federation plans to meet with the one who gets elected and have a discussion about problems that remain unresolved.

Otteri Nullah

Sandhya notes that Greater Chen-

nai Corporation (GCC) has done significant flood mitigation work at the Otteri Nullah, even factoring in FOARA's inputs from time to time. This initiative has indeed reduced flooding risks in Anna Nagar. However, continued monitoring and maintenance are required. Effluents entering the Otteri Nullah are causing toxic air conditions, resulting in damage to household electrical appliances, the classic example being AC units needing replacement every two years, she adds.

"Free up space"

Sandhya observes that FOARA wants pedestrian space restored to pedestrians. "Anna Nagar has a pronounced ageing population; 80 percent of the residents are senior citizens. Unauthorised eateries operating on roads and pavements are a big no-no. Streets are being taken over by vendors. Our position is clear: either enforce strict "No Vending Zones" or create designated vending zones where all ven-



dors can operate in an organised manner. Currently, no properly designated vending zones exist, despite earlier proposals which were abandoned midway," she explains.

Sandhya hastens to point out that the main issue is peak-hour

roadside vending post 5 p.m., which hampers mobility. Late-night food vans that arrive after 9 p.m. are not a major concern.

Parking policy failure

A classic, textbook example of a

TWO MAJOR ISSUES ON THE STREETS OF ANNA NAGAR.

half measure, an unfinished business is the parking policy framing for the streets of Anna Nagar. The effort started with much fanfare. A comprehensive parking plan proposed by CUMTA raised residents' hopes, says Sandhya, and they were disappointed to see it being diluted, the baton being passed to Greater Chennai Corporation. What residents are now left with: zero clarity and no visible sign of progress. This reflects a broader pattern: policies are announced but weakened or abandoned during implementation, she adds

Metro advantage 'diluted'

Sandhya calls Metro rail a boon to the commuting population. She is a diehard fan of the Metro, making use of it to head to the Alandur court, as she is an advocate. The section is served by Anna Nagar East Metro, Anna Nagar Tower Metro and Thirumangalam Metro, but due to lack of last-mile connectivity, patronage of Metro Rail among residents of this region is dipping, she says, adding that residents obviously do not relish having to depend on autos to cover the home stretch.

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‘Restore Thangal Eri’

Residents of Britannia Nagar, a neighbourhood in Madhavaram Assembly Constituency, seek a renewed focus on lake conservation, merger of Wards 31 and 32 and provision of underground electricity cable system



R. SRIDHAR

Restoration of Thangal Eri, a waterbody in Surapet, tops the list of election demands for Britannia Nagar Residents Welfare Association in Kathirvedu, a neighbourhood in Madhavaram Assembly Constituency.

The waterbody is in a deplorable state. A wide range of discards are dumped and sewage is discharged into the waterbody. Further, carcasses of animals have been found on the bunds of the waterbody. It is also overrun with vegetation. If maintained well, the waterbody will help in the recharge of ground-water table. A park should be created around it. For the past few years, the Association is pursuing this issue with the authorities con-

cerned but our efforts have gone in vain. Another major demand is merging of the Greater Chennai Corporation Wards: 31 (Kathirvedu) and 32 (Surapet). Britannia Nagar is spread across these two Wards. For any issue, we have to approach two sets of officials of Greater Chennai Corporation, Chennai Metropolitan Water Supply & Sewerage Board, and two Ward Councillors, which makes things extremely inconvenient. Yet another demand is the provision of underground electricity cable facility. Work began in 2020 but did not progress due to legal issues. This should be addressed at the earliest. Other demands include laying of roads and installation of street lamps.

R. Sridhar is the president of Britannia Nagar Residents Welfare Association.



Thangal Eri, a waterbody in Surapet. The images were taken on December 18, 2025.

PHOTOS: UMESH KUMAR . V



‘FEED’ THE WHALE, RECEIVE A BAG

A Chennai-based startup is populating the sands of Marina with “whales” and “fish” that function as reverse vending machines, dispensing a cloth bag for every PET bottle dropped in them. **P7**

Cultural event at Korattur lake



Korattur Aeri Padukappu Makkal Iyakkam, a citizens group that is engaged in conservation of Korattur lake, organised its annual lake festival at the waterbody recently. It was marked by a sacred offering of pongal to the lake, says a press release. Besides, various games and cultural events were held. The event aims to spread awareness about lake conservation, the release adds.

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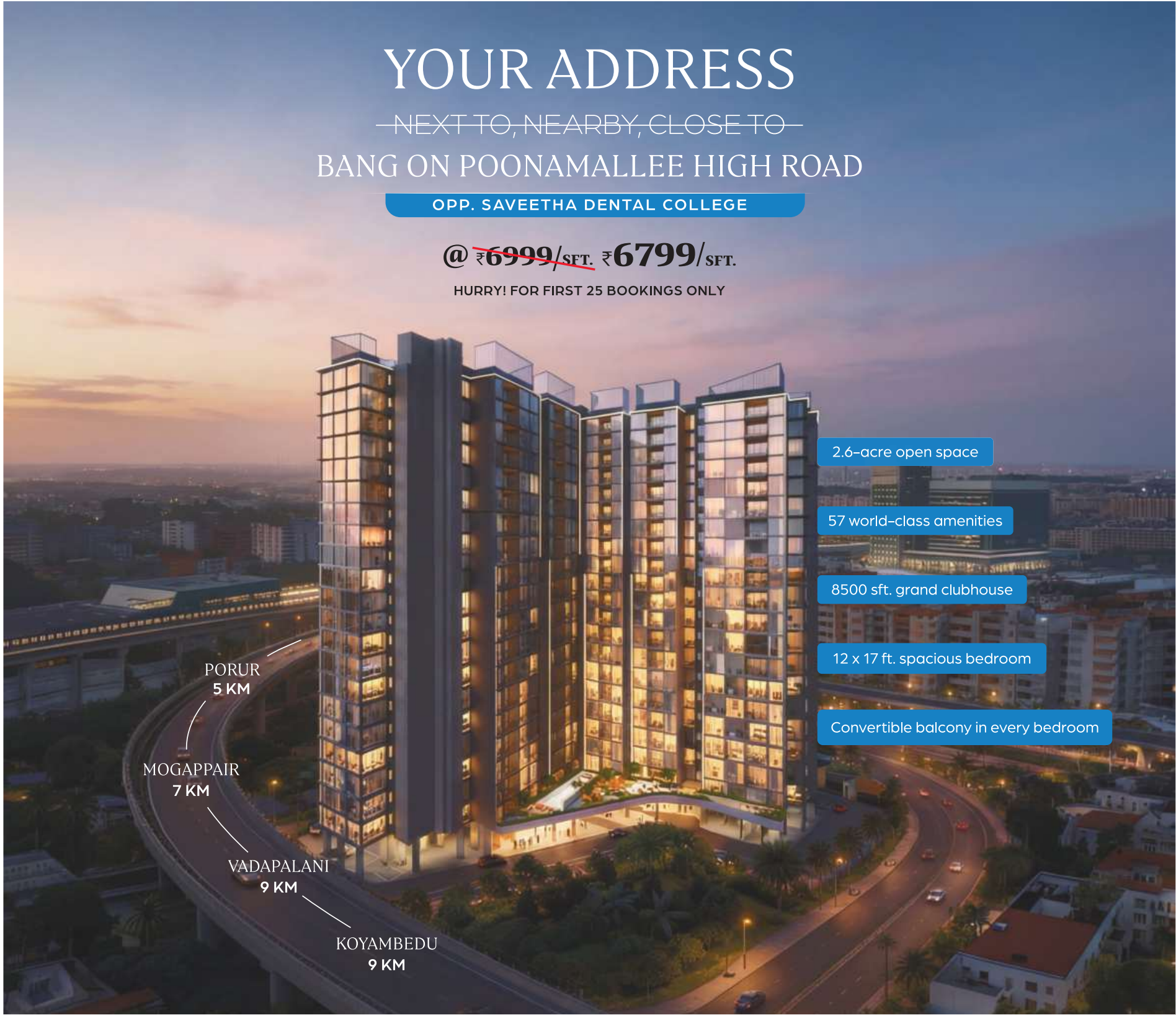
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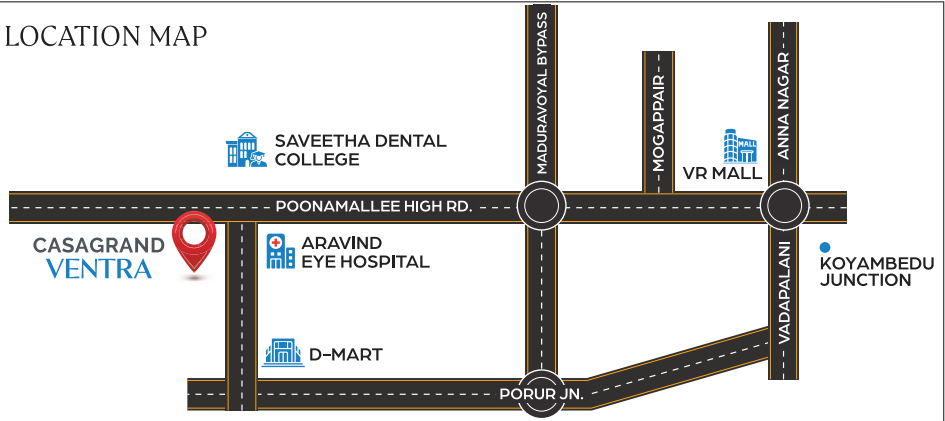
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Solid waste clogs water channel



Kamaraj Nagar residents seek resumption of bridge reconstruction work

K. KANAGAVEL

Avadi Corporation demolished the bridge across a water channel in Kattabomman Street on Kamaraj Nagar Main Road off New Military Road in Avadi, a month ago.

Following the demolition, there has been no sign of work to this day. Residents have to take a detour to cross the channel.

Besides, the section of water channel along Kamaraj Nagar Main Road is poorly maintained; garbage is dumped along the channel which carries excess water from the Vizhinjimbakkam lake nearby.

The garbage remains uncleared for months clogging the waterbody. The channel should be fenced to prevent garbage dumping. This channel plays a key role in mitigating floods in the neighbourhood, hence its upkeep is crucial.

And spot marred by dumping of garbage is the intersection of Kattabomman



The demolished bridge at Kattabomman Street on Kamaraj Nagar Main Road off New Military Road in Avadi; and (left) the sorry state of the water channel. The images were taken on April 6, 2026.

Street and Kamaraj Nagar Main Road. A place of worship and an electricity transformer are located there.

On account of garbage dumping at this spot, the staff from the electricity department struggle to carry fault-rectification

work.

Further, a spark from the transformer raises the risk of a fire accident. Therefore, for safety seasons, the place should be tied up and the transformer fenced.

K. Kanagavel is a resident of Avadi

Piles of garbage along key road in Noombal



Krishna Nagar Main Road in Noombal.
PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

P. SENTHIL KUMAR

Three sections of Krishna Nagar Main Road at Noombal in Thiruverkaadu Municipality are marked by waste trails.

The waste includes plastic, debris, bio-medical waste and offal from slaughter houses.

Waste is allowed to accumulate for months, and cleared once in four to six months. These images say it all. Besides,

instead of being disposed of responsibly, it is set on fire.

This situation has continued for many years now, and has aggravated in the last five years.

Toxins from the waste mounds can enter the food chain as cattle owners who sell milk allow their cows to feed on these waste pile-ups.

The place is fly-blown and infested with rodents giving room for disease outbreaks. There is leaching, and groundwa-

ter can be affected. There are no waste bins on the road. Further, door-to-door collection of waste is also erratic.

This is a one-kilometre road connecting Pillayarmadathangal (Mettu Street) in Iyyappanthangal and Perumal Kovil Street in Noombal.

The road is secluded and traffic movement is low; this could probably be one of the reasons Thiruverkaadu Municipality is not attending to this issue.

P. Senthil Kumar is a resident of Iyyappanthangal



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**'Food litter on roads
of Anna Nagar'**

SANDHYA SANKAR

People feeding cows litter the roads of Anna Nagar. This has become a common sight. In some cases, people throw food at the cows. This shows absolute disregard and contempt for a public space. Complaints to the Greater Chennai Corporation were to no avail.

Sandhya Sankar is a resident of Anna Nagar

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DG Vaishnav celebrates 61st College Day

Dwaraka Doss Goverdhan Doss Vaishnav College celebrated its 61st College Day on April 6, recognising academic excellence, institutional achievements and the talent and abilities of its students.

A press release notes that the programme commenced with a vibrant cultural performance by students of Srinath Fine Arts, based on the theme "Heaven". The performances were skilful, creative and mesmerising, showcasing the exceptional talents of the students,

says the release.

An Audio-Visual (AV) presentation was screened, highlighting the academic achievements, co-curricular activities, faculty accomplishments, and various milestones of the institution over the academic year 2025-2026.

The welcome address was delivered by college secretary Ashok Kumar Mundhra. He welcomed the chief guest, Prof. Balaji Ramakrishnan, director, National Institute of Ocean Technology, and the guest of honour, J. Arun, general manager -

human resources, Ashok Leyland.

Principal S. Santhosh Baboo presented the College Day Report, highlighting the key achievements of the academic year 2025-2026. The report emphasised significant faculty research contributions and innovative initiatives such as Mega boot camp, Hackathon, notable achievement in sports such as AL Mudhaliar's Trophy, active involvement of students in NSS, NCC, and extension programmes such as blood donation camp and antidrug cycle rally.

Hayavadhana The Shloka School organises grand annual day fete



Hayavadhana The Shloka School celebrated its fourth annual day on April 4 at a grand function at Ganesh Mandali in Nanganallur.

A press release says the all-day event was marked by a blending of *Iyal*, *Isai* and *Nadagam*, thanks to school students taking the stage. They presented skits on Nava vidha bhakthi and Azhwargalin kaliyuga varugai; a villupaattu and a folk dance. More than 150 students participated in the annual day celebrations.

Hayavadhana school operates online, so the annual day celebration was an occasion for students to meet each other and their guru and Hayavadhana founder Janani Sundar in person. Chief guest U. Ve. Velukkudi Krishnan lauded Janani's exemplary work. Janani is a

Hyderabad resident and offers online shloka classes to anyone who is interested.

She started the school during the Corona lockdown and from one student then, currently the school has now grown to more than 500 students who reside in different countries. These classes are offered free of charge.

Some of the shlokas taught by her so far are: 4000 Divya Prabandham, Devi Mahathmiam, Bhagavad Gita, Bhagavatha Puranam, Narayaneeyam, Yadavabudhyam, Padhuka Sahasram, Abirami Andhadhi, Soundarya Lahari, Shivananda Lahari, Mooka Panchashathi, Sundara Kandam, Devi Narayaneeyam and Krishna Karnamrutham.

For more information or to enrol, contact Janani via email Viswajanani85@gmail.com

Winners of Gita chanting competition receive prizes

The prize distribution ceremony was held at Chinmaya Vidyalaya on Taylors Road recently

Chinmaya Mission Chennai hosted the Tamil Gita Chanting Competition 2025 prize distribution ceremony at Chinmaya Vidyalaya, Taylors Road. The event celebrated devotion, discipline, and cultural learning.

Chief Guest Leena Nair, IAS (retd.), addressed the gathering, commending the initiative for nurturing devotion and discipline among youth.

O.V. Nambiar, president, Chinmaya Mission Chennai; and Swami Sureshananda, Chinmaya Mission Chennai, were among those who took part.

Swami Mitrananda, head of Chinmaya Mission Chennai, an-



▼ The winners with the dignitaries.

nounced that the Tamil Gita Chanting competitions will be an annual event.

According to a press release, prize winners (senior category) are: Sriman Srivatsan, Vidya Mandir Senior Secondary School, Mylapore (first), Sahana S., Chinmaya Vidyalaya, Taylors Road (second), and Shriya S., Chinmaya Vidyalaya, Virugambakkam (third). In the junior category, winners are Vasundaraa K.A., Chinmaya Vidyalaya, Anna Nagar (first), Ramesh Sai Krupa, Chinmaya Vidyalaya Higher Secondary School, Virugambakkam (second), and Neha G., Bala Vidya Mandir Senior Secondary School, Adyar (third).

The winners were awarded cars (first prize), scooters (second prize), and bicycles (third prize), added the release.

'Feed' the whale, receive a bag

LIFFY THOMAS

A whale 12 feet tall if it stood on its fluke, sits squat on the sands of the Marina Beach. It is a shape-shifter of a whale, combining the contours of a bin and a cloth bag. It is both of these things rolled into one: drop a PET bottle in the bin and get a cloth bag as reward. When one drops a PET bottle in this reverse vending machine, they might appear to be feeding a whale because of the machine's design.

Needless to say it is not a whale.

"InstaBin", as this contraption is called, started operating since April 6, near the Marina swimming pool. Two more reverse vending machines, both designed to resemble a whales, are expected to hit the sands of the Marina next week. In addition, six fish-shaped reverse vending machines have been placed at strategic points between the Light House and Anna Memorial section of the beach.

Chennai-based startup InstaGood's design to reward those showing civic sense at public places is drawing considerable attention both online and on the ground.

The firm came up with the idea after seeing a similar machine being placed at Elliot's Beach in Besant Nagar fail on account of people dropping stones instead of PET bottles.

"Our 'Meendum Man-

japai" (automated machine to dispense cloth bags) machines were already at 60 locations and that is when we thought we should design an Indian version of reverse vending machine where people do not have to pay anything and concerns such as people dropping hard objects should be countered," says Krishna Priyadarshini Elanchezhian, CEO, InstaGood.

Their first machine was placed at Lulu Mall in Bengaluru, where the management wanted to give loyalty coupons to those drop-

Insta solutions

Krishna Priyadarshini Elanchezhian and Vijayaragavan Visuvamithiran, two classmates from College of Engineering Guindy are the founders of InstaGood. The startup manufactures and designs smart vending machines. InstaCoCo, an automatic coconut water vending machine, was their first product.

"The product did face considerable challenge and after a lull we came up with a mask vending machine during the pandemic, which did very well," says Vijayaragavan, a junior research fellow from the biophotonics lab at IIT-Madras who oversees the tech aspects.

They started the enterprise with a seed fund of ₹ 5 lakh

and today are happy with the response they been getting for it various vending machines (InstaPad, InstaBin and InstaBag).

"All our tech-driven solutions reduce waste and is sustainable," says Vijayaragavan.

ping PET bottles. This was followed by another machine placed at Commercial Street in Bangalore with Ranstad India as sponsor.

The patented design slowly started getting corporates' attention. As part of its CSR outreach, Swiss banking software firm Temenos sponsored five machines in Chennai, which can be spotted at Thiruvottiur Thangal bus stop, Marina beach, Broadway bus stand, Koyambedu flower market and Besant Nagar beach.

Later, they bagged the tender from Greater Chennai Corporation for placing nine machines at Marina, work on which is still on. The company manufactures and maintains the machine and sees this as a viable model to reduce single use plastics in cities.

The design

By virtue of live cameras installed

in them, these IoT-enabled machines collect real time data. There is no need for manpower except when the dropped PET bottles have to be collected and transported. "This ideally requires a roof but we have not come across any issues in the last three months, so they are kept in the open," she says.

The team has been tweaking the design based on inputs from the ground. For instance, the one placed at Marina beach was incorporated with sound to speak to the public dropping the bottle but that feature got lost amidst the sound of waves.

The machine accepts anything but only dispenses a cloth bag for the PET bottle dropped.

To ensure people do not walk away with multiple cloth bags to litter them on the sands, the team has tweaked the programme so that the waiting time is made lon-

A Chennai-based startup is populating the sands of Marina with "whales" and "fish" that function as reverse vending machines, dispensing a cloth bag for every PET bottle dropped in them

One of the three whale-shaped reverse vending machines at the Marina Beach; and (below) the fish-shaped one; and co-founders Krishna Priyadarshini and Vijayaragavan. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



ger. "Initially, some were taking multiple bags and we wanted to restrict that. Our R&D team has increased the time to get the bag to two minutes, thereby discouraging people from taking multiple bags," she says.

Depending on the size of the machine, the holding capacity varies. The one sponsored by Temenos can dispense 500 bags a day.

What happens to the PET bottles?

The bottles are collected and transported to InstaGood's office in Madipakkam where they are segregated into three components - wrapper, cap and bottle. "The recyclable value gets higher when they are separated and various by-products can be made; we created key chains from them," she says, adding that they get a certificate from the recycler.

At Koyambedu, are these machines facing competition with Meendum Manjapai vending machines installed by the Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board where a small fee has to be paid to get a cloth bag?

"We had such misgivings but to our surprise, though both were just 20 feet apart, they are in good demand," she says.

The team is working with corporates who are ready to reward the public in the form of eco points. "Once a PET bottle is dropped, the machine verifies and gives reward points (communicated on one's mobile) that can be redeemed," she says.



PLAN YOUR WEEK

Free camp in
Anna Nagar

Sugam Psychological Counselling and Research Center is conducting a free camp to assess mental well being among teens to understand their anger, stress, anxiety and confidence level. For registration, contact Asha Dinesh 9444084946.

The camp is happening on April 12; 10 a.m. onwards at 1132, I block, 35th street, Anna Nagar.

Three-month
Telugu course
from April 18

The World Telugu Federation is conducting a three month Telugu course from April 18 at its premises at Ankur Plaza, Second Floor, South Wing, 113 G.N. Chetty Road, T. Nagar. Time: From 3 p.m. to 4 p.m. According to a press release, no fee will be charged. For details, call 7305557322

Vishu and Tamil New Year celebration in Anna Nagar



Tamil New Year and Vishu will be celebrated at Ayyappa Temple Anna Nagar on April 14 and April 15 respec-

tively. The temple will open from 5 a. m. and elaborate arrangements will be made to enable devotees to make

various offerings like archana and pushpanjali. This year, Vishu will be celebrated on April 15 and the temple will open at 4 a.m. for devotees to see Vishukani. Temple Melshanthi Rajsekharan Nambudiri will give Vishukaineettam to all devotees at Sreeekovil Sopanam upto 7 a.m and thereafter junior priests will continue this at the west-facing Natamantapam, said a press release.

Devotees will also be given laddu as prasadam. In the evening there will be Pushpabhishekam at 5.45 pm and Chuttu Vilakku at 6.30 p.m. For details, contact temple office on 7448813282.

Meeting of Anna
Nagar Humour Club

The monthly meeting of Anna Nagar Humour Club will be held on April 12 at Shri Krishnaswamy Vidhyashram, 914 / J - Block 15th street / Vaigai Colony, Anna Nagar West at 4 p.m.

Sankaranarayanan, auditor, will preside. Dr A Anantharamakrishnan will crack jokes about April Fool. R. Rangadorai, R. Sivakumar, and Kamala Eswaran will tell jokes on various events of this month. All are welcome.

For details, contact Rakshith 94441 71247/ Sivakumar 81909 06675.

A message in Rangoli



Students of Valliammal College for Women in Anna Nagar drew rangolis to create awareness about the importance of voting. PHOTO: M. PRABHU

Short film contest draws teams across India

The Department of Visual Communication, Faculty of Science and Humanities, SRM Institute of Science and Technology, Vadapalani Campus, organised "Jump Cut 2026", a national-level short film competition, on April 7, 2026, at the prestigious LV Prasad Studio. A total of 78 entries were received nationwide, reflecting diverse themes, narratives and cinematic

approaches, says a press release. In the final round, selected films were screened before an audience and jury. The panel of judges comprised Tamil film director Aravind Raj and cinematographer and Tamil film director Shanmugsundaram, who evaluated the films based on storytelling, technical excellence and overall cinematic impact.

The first prize, carrying a cash award of ₹20,000, was awarded to a participant from the Film and Television Institute of India in Pune. The second prize (₹15,000) was secured by a participant from Shiv Nadar University, while the third prize (₹10,000) went to a participant from PSG College of Arts and Science, says the press release.

Creative summer camp from April 20

Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan, Chennai Kendra is starting "Creative Summer Camp 2026" in performing arts, yoga, arts and crafts, sloka chanting, games and puzzles and cultural tours from April 20.

The short-term courses cater to all age groups, with expert instructors guiding each course to ensure personalised attention and a wholesome experience, said a release. Courses offered include computer classes, AI in everyday life, keyboard, drawing and painting, free style dance, yoga, and vocal music.

The camp is on from April 20 to May 31; 10 a.m. to 1 p.m. Short term courses are on from May 1st to May 31

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Unsung Heroes Award presented to women from armed forces



At the award function.

The seventh edition of the Unsung Heroes Award, hosted by the Rotary Club of Madras East, honoured women from armed forces who have risen above personal loss and grief to serve society with strength, dignity, and purpose.

This year's awards, sponsored by the Congruent Foundation, recognised extraordinary individuals

whose service to society often goes unnoticed yet creates profound and lasting impact, said a release.

The awardees are: Metamorphes Foundation, represented by Veer Naari Shakunthala A. Bhandarkar, co-founder and director, wife of Late Col. Bhandarkar, a Shaurya Chakra awardee, whose work reflects resilience and unwavering

commitment to supporting fellow Veer Naris.

Veer Ratna Foundation (VRF), founded by Subhashini Venugopal, wife of Late Col. Venugopal, an Ashoka Chakra awardee, and represented by Archana Chakravarthy, CEO, continuing a mission dedicated to the welfare and empowerment of martyrs' families.

An initiative to empower residents of Royapuram

NVMM Institute of Job Skills invites interested individuals to explore a career in teaching

NVMM Institute of Job Skills, which has been running various programmes to empower youth in Royapuram, has added a new initiative to its list: teacher training.

Professor K.Narashiman, who re-

tired from Anna University; and N.Vijayee, who retired from Tamil Nadu Electricity Board are starting government-approved diploma courses in teacher training.

The one-year diploma course of Bharat Sevak Samaj, a Government

of India initiative, will help develop skill and enrich job opportunities. The programmes are centred around Montessori and Child Education. The courses will be a wonderful opportunity for youth and adults to build a career in teaching at a very low fees with flexi timings, said a release.

The two retired professional are residents of Kotturpuram and were brought up in North Chennai. Since 2022, they have been running programmes to develop the region through education especially among the youth.

For details, call 9444777661, 9444760489



Akshaya Tiritiya offer

Akshaya Tiritiya, one of the most auspicious days to invest in gold, silver and precious jewellery, will be observed on April 19.

Lalithaa Jewellery is offering prices that are lower than competitive rates, ensuring customers receive more for every rupee that is being spent. As part of the festive offering, customers can get a one percent discount on the prevailing gold rate on all gold jewellery purchases, resulting in better value per gram, said a press release. For those looking to invest in diamonds, the jewellery mart is offering ₹ 4,000 per carat.



The offer is valid from April 12 to 20, the release added. In addition, Lalithaa continues its commitment to transparent pricing by offering zero percent value addition on all gold coins, making them an ideal choice for both investment and gifting. Silver buyers can also benefit from no wastage and making charges on 90 percent of silverware, ensuring affordability without hidden costs. Further enhancing the offering are Lalithaa's flexible purchase and savings plans, designed to make jewellery buying more convenient and rewarding. Customers can benefit from 100 percent no-value-addition on jewellery purchase plans, along with pre-booking options that allow them to secure jewellery at favourable prices, stated the release.

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